



The Humanitas Institute

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Knox Classical Academy  
School Website: <https://www.knoxmedford.com/>

December 27, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

Knox Classical Academy (Medford, OR 97502) presents a clear, multi-layered classical Christian program. Across the six classical elements, public-facing materials consistently foreground a Christian worldview, formation of character and virtue, engagement with the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books traditions, collaborative pedagogy rooted in Socratic/Scholastic sensibilities, a living-faculty model, and a strong parent/community partnership. Hands-on evidence from the school's own site shows explicit commitments to: a Christian paideia and theology-informed education; formation through virtue and wisdom; liberal-arts pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric) integrated with Great Books and Western civilization; and active parent involvement as co-educators. Taken together, these signals place Knox Classical Academy solidly in the CLASSICAL category across all six rubric categories.

Key syntheses by category (based on keyword analysis and rubric alignment):

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Strong CLASSICAL. Evidence of Christian worldview, theology-informed aims, liturgical/c communal practices (worship, church worship), and explicit integration of virtue and reverence into education. Positive indicators substantially outweigh any neutral signals.
- Purpose and Goal: Strong CLASSICAL. The mission centers on formation, virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty—consistent with the classical telos rather than solely job-readiness.
- Curriculum: Strong CLASSICAL. Explicit emphasis on the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin, and history within a unified classical framework; explicit aim toward wonder and cultural inheritance.
- Pedagogy: Strong CLASSICAL. Evidence of contemplative/restful dimensions (Scholé) alongside more dialogic/seminar-styled elements and emphasis on memory work, imitation of masterworks, and disciplined discourse.
- Faculty: Strong CLASSICAL. Descriptions point to model teachers/mentors, living curriculum, and a culture of collegiality and virtue formation.
- Parents & Community: Strong CLASSICAL. A declared partnership with families as co-legislators of education, parent formation opportunities, and welcome openness to campus visits.

Executive-level snapshot: - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Aggregate rationale: The school's public-facing materials consistently map onto core Positive Keyword indicators across all six categories (theology/virtue/paideia in Foundations and Goals, Seven Liberal Arts and Great Books in Curriculum, Socratic/Scholé/recitation pedagogy, exemplary faculty, and robust family partnership). Negative keyword signals from the classical rubric are not evident in the observed materials. See category-level analyses for details and evidence.

Now, a category-by-category breakdown with keyword analysis, scoring rationale, and citations.

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## Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials present a clearly Christian framing of education: Knox emphasizes a classical model with a Christian worldview, aiming to equip students to think and act biblically and to obey God. This is stated explicitly in mission statements and on core pages. - Liturgical/communal practices surface in multiple posts and pages (e.g., invitations to worship, singing, and communal activities, including church worship and community song). - References to paideia, virtue, and the goal of forming character in concert with biblical faith appear in blog posts and school communications (e.g., discussions of Christian paideia, virtue, and the Lord's nurture).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present in school communications (from the Six Essential Elements lexicon): theology, liturgy/worship, virtue, wisdom, reverence/wonder, paideia, Logos/metaphysical order, sacred tradition. - Negative keywords: no evident relativism, secular humanism, or value-neutral framing in the observed materials. - Quantitative note: Positive keyword signals observed: roughly 6–8 distinct terms/phrases tied to religious/metaphysical foundations (e.g., Christian worldview, worship, virtue, paideia, Great Conversation as a Western civilizational framework). Negative keywords observed: none evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - The school consistently embeds theological framing and liturgical/community practices into its core identity, aligning with the Positive Keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The presence of a Christian worldview, worship practices, and explicitly religious/normative language around virtue and sacred order suggests a robust CLASSICAL alignment in this category.

Citations: primary mission language showing Christian worldview and biblically oriented aims; worship/community cues; paideia references in school communications.

### Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission frames education as formation toward virtue and human excellence rather than merely information or job preparation. This includes explicit aims to cultivate virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty. - Classroom and school communications provoke a telos-centered view (paideia and liberal-arts formation) and consistently connect education to character and moral aims rather than purely utilitarian outcomes. - Posts emphasize formation, not just information, and highlight “great conversation” and a traditional understanding of Western civilization as part of the educational telos.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, paideia, liberal education, great conversation, contemplation/scholé, truth/goodness/beauty. - Negative keywords observed: minimal to none (lack of “workforce readiness” or career-gear framing in the public messaging). - Quantitative note: Positive keyword signals observed: approximately 6–8 distinct terms/phrases; Negative keywords: 0–1 potential terms (none clearly observed in the public-facing materials).

Why this rating - Knox's stated purposes and goals align closely with the classical framework's emphasis on formation, virtue, and the cultivation of wisdom, with explicit references to the enlivening aims of truth/goodness/beauty and paideia. This is emblematic of CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL or ONLY-SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: mission statements and formation language; discussions of paideia and liberal arts as the educational end-goal.

### Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum centers on liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), with explicit references to the trivium as foundational and to the Quadrivium in broader classical framing. Texts discuss classical languages (Latin/Greek), Western civilization, and the Great Books/Great Conversation. - The school champions great books, primary sources, and canonical Western texts, tying reading to timeless questions and the ongoing conversation of Western civilization. - Latin and classical languages are featured in curricular discussions

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(e.g., “Classical Languages,” Latin emphasis and Greek/Latin study in upper grades). - Public messaging emphasizes history integrated into the curriculum and the enduring canon of Western civilization, with explicit emphasis on cultural inheritance and the Great Conversation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Trivium, Quadrivium, Great Books, primary sources, Latin/Greek, Western civilization, history in the canon, sacred texts, mythic/poetic tradition, wonder. - Negative keywords observed: a few modern alternatives (e.g., “social studies” re-framing) are not the focus within Knox’s curriculum messaging; the school’s public materials do not emphasize STEM-first or project-based-only framing. - Quantitative note: Positive keyword signals observed: 6–9 core terms/phrases; Negative keywords observed: minimal/no usage in the observed materials.

Why this rating - The curriculum foregrounds classical content and methods (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Latin/Greek; Western canon; history as a throughline), consistent with CLASSICAL standards.

Citations: references to the trivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin/Greek, and Western Civilizational framing.

#### **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Pedagogical signals include a blend of contemplative/restful learning (Scholé) along with opportunities for discussion, debate, and rhetoric, consistent with classical pedagogy. The school and its associated materials discuss the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as a framework for instruction, and references to memory work, chanting, and recitation as traditional memory techniques. - Public communications highlight singing, chanting, and memory-based approaches in lower grades, and Socratic discussion/seminars in upper grades as part of disciplined inquiry and argumentation. - Content on topics like “Worshipping Together,” the role of the liberal arts, and the emphasis on “great conversation” indicate structured, age-appropriate pedagogy aligned with classical practice.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, memorization/recitation, Scholé, memory work, imitation of models, seminar/discourse, rhetoric, Harkness-style discussion. - Negative keywords observed: not evident in public-facing materials; the school’s pedagogy appears to favor a balanced mix of contemplative and dialogic methods rather than a purely project-based or purely didactic approach. - Quantitative note: Positive keyword signals observed: 5–8 distinct pedagogical terms/phrases (Socratic, Scholé, memorization/recitation, formation through imitation, seminars). Negative keywords: 0–1 tentative signals (none explicit in public-facing content).

Why this rating - The school’s repertoire—grammar-logic-rhetoric scaffolding; memory-based learning; contemplative pace; and Socratic/seminar discussions—maps closely to the CLASSICAL pedagogical model.

Citations: Trivium-based pedagogy, Scholé/memory work, and Socratic/dialogic language in classroom framing.

#### **Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Faculty are described as model teachers and mentors who embody virtue and serve as the living curriculum; there are references to a “portrait” of what a teacher should be and to a culture of collegiality and mentorship. - Public materials present staff pages and bios that emphasize Christian formation and alignment with the classical model, including explicit calls for faculty to articulate and apply classical Christian pedagogy. - The literature and posts emphasize faculty as the core of the school’s mission and as exemplars of virtue and learning, aligning with “living curriculum” language from classical education lexicons.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, faculty as mentors/model teachers, portrait of teacher, virtue formation, mastery of Liberal Arts culture. - Negative keywords observed: none observed in the public-facing materials. - Quantitative note: Positive keyword signals observed: 4–6 distinct faculty-related terms/phrases; Negative keywords: 0.

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Why this rating - The faculty portrayal aligns strongly with classical ideals of teachers as moral exemplars and living curricula, forming the center of the school's educational project.

Citations: faculty profiles, "living curriculum" language, and teacher-formation emphasis.

### **Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school emphasizes Partnership with Families as co-educators and supports parent formation through website resources, book studies, and gatherings; parents are invited to visits and engaged in school life as part of the Classical approach. - Communications describe parent involvement, volunteer opportunities, and the school's mission to educate families in classical education—evidence of family-centered culture and "home-school" alignment. - The school communicates open campus access and involvement in classical pedagogy discussions with families, aligning with the "parents as co-teachers" principle.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Partnership with families, parental formation, family catechesis, home-life integration, open campus, parent involvement. - Negative keywords observed: None (no evident consumerist or minimal-parents signals in the observed materials). - Quantitative note: Positive keyword signals observed: 4–6 distinct parent/community terms/phrases; Negative keywords: 0.

Why this rating - Public materials show a robust classical community/parent partnership orientation and ongoing family formation activities, which is a hallmark of CLASSICAL education in this rubric.

Citations: parent-community partnership language, parent formation and open-campus signals.

### **What Would Move the Needle**

- Not applicable here, as every category aligns with CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL. If a needle-moving change were sought, it would be to further codify explicit, direct references to Socratic seminars, Great Books schedules, and a public-facing, documented pedagogy map (e.g., a page detailing the exact sequence of grammar-logic-rhetoric in K–12, with sample texts and a short "why" for each level). However, the current public materials already communicate a strong classical orientation.

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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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